

PROFILE

Dynamic Application Security Engineer with over 13 years of experience driving security initiatives and embedding security practices into the software development lifecycle. Proven ability to identify and remediate vulnerabilities in web applications, APIs, and cloud environments while collaborating effectively with development and DevOps teams. Expert in utilizing security automation tools, including SAST, DAST, and SCA, to streamline processes and enhance application resilience. Recognized for effectively communicating complex security concepts, fostering a culture of security awareness, and ensuring compliance throughout the organization. Committed to promoting secure coding practices and advancing the overall security posture of applications.

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Senior Application Security Engineer, Ciena, Hanover MD

DECEMBER 2022 – SEPTEMBER 2025

- **INE PTP certification** - In Progress with expected completion by **Winter 2025**.
- Joined Ciena's Application Security team to assist internal application development within Ciena to ensure that applications were hardened and did not pose a threat of exploitation to Ciena's customers.
- Coordinated with internal developers and created a Tier list for internal applications based on their role, data sensitivity and network exposure.
- Assisted with project to identify Source Code repos and align them with corporate efforts to identify, scan and automate vulnerability assessments.
- Created numerous lunch and learn workshops for application developers on trending vulnerabilities.
- Integrated 20+ Tier 1 applications into SAST (SonarQube) and DAST (Rapid7 AppSec) and configured dependency scanning into CI/DC pipelines as to create an automation scanning solution.
- Reduced vulnerabilities found in internal software by over **78%** in **8 months**.
- Proactively reviewed metrics and created common vulnerabilities trending data metrics for management.
- Met with Engineering and Development teams to identify valid vulnerabilities, remove false positives, create a realistic and acceptable remediation plans and follow up to ensure that processes were being adhered.
- Assisted with the development of coding standards and security rules in an effort to "shift left" and catch security issues much earlier in the application development life cycle.
- Utilized JIRA for tracking remediation efforts and to follow up application developers.
- Assisted with the security assessments of SBOMS using well established SCA scanner (BlackDuck).
- Setup automated and scheduled security assessments on internal web application and APIs (Rapid7 & Burp Suite with Postman).
- Adhered to established frameworks such as OWASP and NIST. Interested in SLSA as a way to mitigate Supply Chain attacks.
- Assisted other internal teams with Threat Modeling exercises and providing that information to senior leadership.
- Created dashboards and assisted other teams with application reporting dashboards using PowerBI and Snowflake.

- Researched existing and emerging CVEs and advised dev teams on new threats before published exploits could impact Ciena's reputation.
- Assisted management with drafting vulnerability metrics and or explaining complex vulnerabilities without the use of confusing tech jargon.
- Recorded 8 training sessions for using DAST / SAST scanning for new team members.

Threat and Vulnerability Management Engineer, Ciena, Hanover MD

JUNE 2017 – DECEMBER 2022

- Monitored emerging CVE threats and developed proactive action plans to mitigate risks.
- Authored CVE alerts for management, coordinating with teams for effective remediation.
- Oversaw compliance with patching policies across Windows Server, Linux, and Macintosh environments.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and penetration testing on Ciena equipment using various tools to ensure that Ciena gear was hardened and not vulnerable to known exploits.
- Implemented best practices for Windows 11 configurations to balance security and user experience.

Security Operations, Ciena, Hanover MD

MAY 2014 – JUNE 2017

- Joined Security Operations team to further develop and expand IT career to focus on Cyber Security.
- Assumed or promoted into product owner of numerous technologies including Mobile Iron MDM email system, RSA 2FA, Anixis Password locker, CyberArk Vault, F5 Load balancer, Checkpoint Firewalls, IT data share auditing, Application packaging and deployment (VPN, Entrust certification, RSA 2FA Windows agent).
- Assisting with the deployment of Bit9, Splunk and assisted the operations of those technologies.
- Created and modified Firewall rules, DNS records, IDS/IPS, email scrubbing and machine hardening (zero trust) projects.

Senior Desktop Support, Ciena, Hanover MD

FEBRUARY 2013 – MAY 2014

- Provided support for Desktop / Laptop systems at the Hanover MD campus as well as research lab machines in our offsite locations.
- Researched new and emerging technologies to be deployed to Windows workstations such as SSD performance gains vs cost effectiveness.
- Traveled to numerous remote Ciena locations for audit/inventory control. - Developed, led and completed a project to upgrade remote employee's laptops from Windows XP to Windows 7 and provided daily updates to Desktop management team and management.
- Obtained ITIL certification in September 2013.

Desktop Support, T. Rowe Price, Owings Mills MD

SEPTEMBER 2011 – FEBRUARY 2013

- Provided onsite support within T. Rowe Price's Owings Mills Campus.
- Assisted with the pre-testing and main test for T. Rowe Price's 2012 Disaster Recovery at their offsite location.
- Authored numerous scripts to automate software installation/uninstalls for training and Software evaluation purposes.
- Troubleshoot all iOS/RIM software & hardware issues for the entire Owings Mills Campus.
- Assigned with coordinating and scheduling the rollout for Microsoft's Active Sync for iOS devices for the entire firm. Duties include attending status meetings, working with testing groups as well as providing timely updates to senior management.
- Worked with numerous teams to roll out Windows 7 and replace XP workstations.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science - History, Towson University, Towson MD

MAY 2001 — MAY 2007

LINKS

[linkedin.com/in/ryan-littlefield-91436a135/](https://www.linkedin.com/in/ryan-littlefield-91436a135/)

SKILLS

Azure DevOPs

Azure Security

SAST - SonarQube

SCA - BlackDuck

JIRA tracking

LLM

Secret scanning - Wiz and SonarQube LTA 2025.1

SLSA

Jenkins

GitLab

DREAD

API technologies: REST, SOAP

OWASP

MISRA

AWS Idenity and Access Management

OKTA SSO

DAST - Rapid7 Appsec

O365

Confluence

SIEM - Splunk

STRIDE

PASTA

Docker

FRAMEWORKS - NIST

Kubernetes

OAuth 2.0, OpenID Connect

NIST CSF

HOBBIES

Military History, Automobiles and PC gaming.